

CircumSurvey Questions

THE ACCIDENTAL INTACTIVIST ASKS: WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON DOWN THERE?



Help Us Get It Right: A Proposal for a More Trans-Inclusive Survey

Hello everyone,

My name is Tone Pettit, and I'm the lead researcher of "The Accidental Intactivist's Inquiry," a large-scale, anonymous survey on the lifelong impacts of non-consensual genital alteration. Our core mission is to document all lived experiences with integrity and respect.

We have received crucial feedback from the trans community that our current survey, while well-intentioned, is inadequate and can be invalidating for trans, intersex, and gender-diverse individuals. Specifically, it makes assumptions about anatomy based on sex assigned at birth and fails to provide space for experiences like Gender Reassignment Surgery (GRS).

We are committed to fixing this. This document is our draft proposal for a new survey structure (Version 2.2). Our goal is to create a survey that is not just "not exclusionary," but is actively welcoming and affirming.

Your feedback is invaluable. Please use the "Comment" feature in this Google Doc to offer any critiques, suggestions, or corrections. Your expertise is what will make this a better, more accurate research instrument.

Thank you for your trust and collaboration!

New Survey Questions & Logic Flow

Proposed New Gateway Question:

- **Question 1: To guide you to the most relevant questions, which of the following statements best describes your primary reason for taking this survey today?**
 - Meta Tag: meta_anatomy_gateway 
 - Description: This survey explores experiences with different genital anatomies and perspectives. Please choose the option that best reflects the primary experience you are here to share.
 - Type: Drop-down
 - Options:
 - My focus is on my experience having a penis (currently). (-> Go to meta_status question:  Intact/ Circumcised/ Restoring)
 - My focus is on my experience as a trans woman who has undergone vaginoplasty. (-> Go to New  Post-Vaginoplasty Pathway)
 - My focus is on my experience as a trans man who has undergone phalloplasty. (-> Go to New  Post-Phalloplasty Pathway)
 - My focus is on my experience as an intersex person. (-> Go to New  Intersex Pathway)
 - I am a woman/AFAB, and I am here to share a general perspective or observations. (-> Go to  Observer - Woman/AFAB Pathway)
 - I am primarily here to observe or share a perspective as a partner, parent, healthcare provider, etc. (-> Go to  Observer - Role-Based Pathway)
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New Sub-Pathway: The Post-Vaginoplasty Experience

Description: Thank you. This section is for AMAB individuals who have undergone vaginoplasty. Your perspective is unique and incredibly valuable, as you can reflect on your past anatomical state from a different vantage point. We recognize this can be a sensitive topic.

- **Proposed Question 1:  Before your gender-affirming surgery, what was the circumcision status of your penis?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_vaginoplasty_pre_op_status

- Type: Single-select (Drop Down)
- Options:
 - Intact
 - Circumcised
 - Unsure
- **Question 40:  Did your pre-surgery circumcision status have any notable impact on your gender-affirming surgery?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_vaginoplasty_surgical_impact
 - Description: For example, some surgical techniques utilize foreskin or penile skin tissue. Did this come up in your consultations, or do you feel it affected the surgical outcome, sensation, or your recovery in any way?
 - Type: Long answer text
- **Question 41:  Looking back now, how do you feel about your pre-surgery circumcision status?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_vaginoplasty_retrospective_feeling
 - Description: For example, do you feel that being circumcised was an early, unrelated form of non-consensual modification, that being intact provided better material for your surgery, or that it was largely an irrelevant factor in your journey?
 - Type: Long answer text
- **Question 42:  Would you be willing to reflect on your experience *before* your GRS?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_vaginoplasty_bridge_to_pathway
 - Description: If you feel comfortable, your perspective is also incredibly valuable to the Intact or Circumcised pathways. Would you be willing to answer some questions from that prior perspective now?
 - Type: Single-select (Radio button list)
 - Options & Logic:
 - Yes, I'm willing to answer questions from my prior perspective as an Intact person. (-> Go to  Intact Pathway)

- Yes, I'm willing to answer questions from my prior perspective as a Circumcised person. (-> Go to  Circumcised Pathway)
- No, I'd prefer to skip that. (-> Go to Final Reflections Section)

New Sub-Pathway: The Post-Vaginoplasty Experience

Section Description: Thank you for sharing your journey. This section is for individuals who have undergone phalloplasty. Your experience provides an invaluable perspective on creating a body that aligns with one's identity. This is a respectful space to share your insights on how circumcision may have intersected with your medical decisions.

- **Question 46:  During your phalloplasty process, was a "circumcised" or "intact" (with a constructed foreskin) appearance a choice you considered or discussed?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_vaginoplasty_pre_op_status
 - Type: Single-select (Radio button list)
 - Options:
 - Yes, I chose an "intact" appearance.
 - Yes, I chose a "circumcised" appearance
 - Yes, it was discussed, but the outcome was determined by surgical technique
 - No, this was not a significant part of my planning
 - I was not aware an "intact" appearance was an option
 - Other
- **Question 47:  If you made a conscious choice regarding appearance, what were the primary factors?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_phalloplasty_motivation
 - Description: (If not applicable, please skip).
 - Type: Mulri-select (Checkboxes)
 - Options:
 - Aesthetic Preference
 - Social Norms
 - Partner Preference

- Sensation
 - Function/Hygiene
 - Personal Identity
 - Surgical Feasibility
 - Other
- **Question 48: ● How satisfied are you with the final outcome, specifically in relation to its circumcised or intact appearance?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_phalloplasty_satisfaction_grid
 - Description: How satisfied are you with the final outcome, specifically in relation to its circumcised or intact appearance?
 - Type: Multiple choice grid
 - Rows:
 - Aesthetic Appearance
 - Sensation
 - Overall sense of bodily congruence
 - Columns:
 - Very Satisfied
 - Somewhat Satisfied
 - Neutral
 - Somewhat Dissatisfied
 - Very Dissatisfied
- **Question 49: ● From your unique perspective of having actively constructed an affirming body, what are your thoughts on performing non-consensual, non-therapeutic genital surgery on infants?**
 - Meta Tag: trans_phalloplasty_autonomy_reflection
 - Type: Open Text
- **Question 50: ● What advice would you offer to another trans person who is in the early stages of planning for phalloplasty, regarding the topic of a circumcised vs. intact appearance?**

- Meta Tag: trans_phalloplasty_advice
- Type: Long answer text

New Sub-Pathway: The Intersex Experience

Section Description: Thank you. This section is for individuals who identify as intersex. Your perspective is essential for understanding the full spectrum of non-consensual genital modifications. We recognize that "intersex" encompasses many different experiences and that medical language can often be inadequate or pathologizing. This is a safe, anonymous space to share your story in your own words.

- **Question 51:**  **How has the topic of non-consensual or "normalizing" genital surgery intersected with your own life and body?**
 - Description: Please feel free to share whatever feels relevant. This could be about surgeries performed on you in infancy or childhood, the choices your parents made, how you feel about your own unique anatomy, or your thoughts on the cultural pressures to conform to a male/female binary
 - Meta Tag: intersex_experience_open
 - Type: Single-select (Radio button list)
 - Type: Open Text
- **Question 53:**  **From your unique perspective, how do you see the common practice of routine infant circumcision in relation to the broader issue of Intersex Genital Mutilation (IGM)?**
 - Meta Tag: intersex_view_on_ric
 - Description: Do you see them as related issues, as completely separate, or something in between? Your insight on this comparison is incredibly valuable.
 - Type: Open Text
- **Question 54:**  **What is the single most important piece of advice you would give to the parents of a newborn intersex child regarding medical interventions?**
 - Meta Tag: intersex_advice_to_parents
 - Description: What is the single most important piece of advice you would give to the parents of a newborn intersex child regarding medical interventions?
 - Type: Open Text

Revised Questions:

Original Question 98 (intact_message_to_others):

● **What's one thing you wish individuals who are circumcised (or parents considering circumcision for their sons) truly understood about the intact penis and the holistic experience of being naturally whole?**

Revised Question 98: ● **What's one thing you wish individuals who are circumcised (or parents considering circumcision for their sons) truly understood about being intact?**

Description: Thinking about the function, sensation, or experience of being intact, if you could share one key insight from your lived experience, what would it be?

Survey Branching Logic Mapping

Google Forms Logic and Branching Guide (v2.2) (Proposed)

This guide outlines the complete branching logic for the survey based on the corrected Master Questions Document.

Section 1: Consent

This is the entry point for all participants. It serves to inform the respondent of the survey's purpose, its anonymous and voluntary nature, and the sensitive content within, culminating in a mandatory consent question.

Question 1: meta_consent - Informed Consent

Logic: This is the only required checkbox. The survey cannot proceed until the user consents. Upon checking the box and clicking "Next," the user is taken to Section 2.

Section 2: Basic Information

Question 2: In which COUNTRY were you BORN?

If United States of America (USA) is selected → Go to Question 6.

If Canada is selected → Go to Question 7.

If Other / Not listed... is selected → Go to Question 3.

Otherwise → Continue to next question (Q3). (Note: This logic is slightly redundant if Q3 is the next question anyway, but explicit logic is safer).

Question 3: Other COUNTRY/TERRITORY of ORIGIN

After answering → Go to Question 4.

Question 4: In which country are you primarily located now?

If United States of America (USA) is selected → Go to Question 8.

If Canada is selected → Go to Question 9.

If Other / Not listed... is selected → Go to Question 5.

Question 5: Other Current COUNTRY/REGION/TERRITORY

After answering → Go to Question 10.

Question 6: In which US STATE or TERRITORY were you BORN?

After answering → Go to Question 4.

Question 7: I was BORN in Canada

After answering → Go to Question 4.

Question 8: In which US STATE or TERRITORY do you live NOW?

After answering → Go to Question 10.

Question 9: Currently or Primarily reside in Canada NOW

After answering → Go to Question 10.

Section 3: Your Lived Experience

Question 38: Overall, how PROUD or satisfied are you with your penis...?

After answering → Go to Question 39.

Section 4: Religious or Cultural Heritage

Question 39: Was religion a significant part of your upbringing?

If Yes, very significant OR Yes, somewhat significant → Go to Question 40.

If Culturally, but no... → Go to Question 41.

If Not at all significant... OR Prefer not to say → Go to Question 65.

Question 40: PRIMARY TRADITION(S): Which religious or spiritual tradition(s)...?

If Christian → Go to Question 42.

If Jewish → Go to Question 46.

If Islamic → Go to Question 55.

If Hinduism, Buddhism, Sikhism, Indigenous, African Diasporic, Pagan, New Age, Secular Humanism, No significant religious..., OR Prefer not to say → Go to Question 65.

Question 41: CULTURAL BACKGROUND

After answering → Go to Question 65.

Question 45: Anything else you'd like to share about your perspective as a Christian?

After answering → Go to Question 65.

Question 54: Have you/your family participated in or considered alternative welcoming ceremonies...?

After answering → Go to Question 65.

Question 64: How do you/your family reconcile the choice of intactness...?

After answering → Go to Question 65.

NEW SECTION: Defining Your Primary Focus

Question [New #]: meta_anatomy_gateway - To guide you to the most relevant questions, which of the following best describes your primary focus for this survey?

If My focus is on my experience having a penis (currently). → Go to meta_status question (What is your circumcision status?).

If  My focus is on my experience as a trans woman who has undergone vaginoplasty. → Go to  Post-Vaginoplasty Pathway.

If  My focus is on my experience as a trans man who has undergone phalloplasty. → Go to  Post-Phalloplasty Pathway.

If  My focus is on my experience as an intersex person. → Go to  Intersex Pathway.

If  I am primarily here to observe... (AFAB or other). → Go to  Observer Pathway Gateway.

Question: meta_status - What is your circumcision status?

(This question is now ONLY seen by those who selected "I have a penis" in the gateway).

If Intact (Never circumcised) → Go to  Intact Pathway.

If Circumcised → Go to  Circumcised Pathway.

If Actively RESTORING... → Go to  Restoration Pathway.

Section 5: Circumcision Status (Major Branching Point)

Question 65: What is your circumcision status?

If Intact (Never circumcised) → Go to Section 5A (Starts at Q66).

If Circumcised → Go to Section 5B (Starts at Q99).

If Actively RESTORING... → Go to Section 5C (Starts at Q145).

If N/A (Observer) → Go to Section 5D (Starts at Q168).

If Not Sure? → Go to Section "Not Sure Which Path?" (Guidance Page).

Section 5A: The Intact Pathway

Question 98: What's one thing you wish individuals who are circumcised... truly understood...?

After answering → Go to Question 269 (Cultural Reflections).

Section 5B: The Circumcised Pathway

Question 102: At what age were you circumcised, if you know?

If Neonatal/Infant OR Childhood OR Unsure → Go to Sub-Pathway: Infant/Childhood Circumcision.

If Adolescence OR Adulthood → Go to Sub-Pathway: Adult/Adolescent Circumcision.

Question 114: If you could send a message to the parents who made the decision for you...?

After answering → Go to Question 124.

Question 140: Before encountering discussions like this survey... how much thought had you given...?

After answering → Go to Question 141.

Question 142: Do you have any male (AMAB) SIBLINGS...?

If No I don't have any brothers... → Go to Question 269.

If Yes, I have 1 through Yes, I have 6 or more → Go to Question 143.

Question 143: What is your siblings' circumcision status in relation to your own?

If All of us are the same: INTACT → Go to Question 269.

If All of us are the same: CIRCUMCISED → Go to Question 269.

If There is a mix (I am INTACT)... → Go to Question 144.

If There is a mix (I am CIRCUMCISED)... → Go to Question 144.

If I don't know the status... → Go to Question 269.

Question 144: Since there is a mix of circumcision statuses... do you know anything about why...?

After answering → Go to Question 269.

Sub-Pathway: Adult/Adolescent Circumcision (New Questions):

This pathway now contains all the new "before and after" questions.

After the final question (circ_adult_final_thoughts) → Go to Sub-Pathway: Your Lived Anatomy (the old "Physical Characteristics" section, which is shared by all circumcised cohorts).

Section 5C: The Restoration Pathway

Question 167: Thank you for sharing insights into your restoration journey!

If Yes, I'm willing to answer questions... → Go to Question 99.

If No, I'd prefer to skip... → Go to Question 141.

Section 5D: The OBSERVER, Partner & Ally Pathway

Question 168: What primarily motivated you to take this survey...?

Logic for all options directs users to the appropriate sub-pathway start question (e.g., Q169 for Parent, Q209 for Partner, etc.).

Question 177: Which of the following best describes your family's situation...?

Logic for all options directs users to the appropriate sub-pathway or question.

Question 187, 196, 204, 216, 235, 241, 248, 255, 260:

Each of these questions marks the end of a specific sub-pathway. The logic for each is to Go to Question 261.

Question 261: Are You Wearing Any Other Hat(s) Today?

Each option directs to the start of another sub-pathway (e.g., Q209 for Partner, Q169 for Parent).

If I am FINISHED with this section... → Go to Question 269.

Question 262: A Note on a Critical Legal Initiative in Washington State

After answering ("Yes" or "No") → Go to Question 263.

Section 5E: The Trans Pathways (New)

Pathway: Post-Vaginoplasty

Question trans_vaginoplasty_bridge_to_pathway: Would you be willing to reflect on your experience *before* your GRS?

If Yes... Intact person. → Go to Intact Pathway.

If Yes... Circumcised person. → Go to Circumcised Pathway.

If No... → Go to Final Reflections Section.

Pathway: Post-Phalloplasty

After the final question (trans_phalloplasty_advice) → Go to Final Reflections Section.

Section 5F: The Intersex Pathways (New)

After the final question (intersex_advice_to_parents) → Go to Final Reflections Section.

Section 6: Cultural Reflections & Final Thoughts

Question 269: culture_body_intervention_view - In general, how do you view the relationship between the human body's natural state and medical interventions?

Logic: After answering → Continue to next question.

... (All subsequent questions in this section, e.g., culture_community_expectation, final_core_principle_choice, etc.) ...

Logic: The flow is linear. Each question proceeds to the next one within the section.

Question 292: final_anything_else - Is there anything else you'd like to share...?

Logic: After answering → Go to Section 7: Outreach, Contact & Survey Completion.

Section 7: Outreach, Contact & Survey Completion

Question 294: Would you be willing to be contacted anonymously...?

If Yes → Go to Question 295.

If No → Submit Form.

Question 298: Are there ways you might feel comfortable sharing...?
After answering → Submit Form.